# Chen Gao

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## Current Position

**Research Assistant** Sep 2026 — Present
Centre for Macroeconomics *London, UK*
London School of Economics and Political Science
Supervisors: Jonathon Hazell, Benjamin Moll, and Ricardo Reis

## Education

**Peking University** Beijing, China
*B.A. in Economics with Honors and Distinction* *Sep 2022 — June 2026*

- **Cumulative GPA:** 3.873/4.0
- **Selected Honors & Awards:** Outstanding Graduate (2026), Outstanding Undergraduate Thesis (2026), Ho-Mou Wu Memorial Scholarship (2026), Outstanding Undergraduate Research Project (2024, funded), ICBC STAR Scholarship, Peking University Scholarship (third prize, twice).
- **Relevant Coursework:** Intermediate Micro/Macro/Econometrics (Honors), Computational Economics (Grad Level) (4.0 / 4.0), Theory of Dynamic Optimization, International Finance, Game Theory, Advanced Mathematics (3.95 & 4.0 / 4.0), Linear Algebra, Mathematical Statistics (3.95 / 4.0), Probability Theory (3.95 / 4.0), Industrial Organization Theory (Honor), Data Analysis and Econometric Programming (3.98 / 4.0)

**University of California, Berkeley** Berkeley, CA
*Visiting Undergraduate* *Jan 2025 — May 2025*

- **Cumulative GPA:** 4.0/4.0
- **Relevant Coursework:** Advanced Macroeconomics (Grad Level) (A+), Real Analysis (A), Numerical Analysis I & II (A)

## Working Papers

**Forecasting Inflation with Microdata: An Adaptive Machine Learning Approach** Jan 2025 — Present

- With Catherine Chen, Jonathon Hazell, Lihua Lei, and Chen Lian
- A recent version can be found here
- **Presented at:** Reykjavík Economic Conference, Bank of England, Stanford Institute for Theoretical Economics (SITE), NBER Summer Institute (2026), UC Berkeley, LSE, Stanford, and Cowles Foundation.

## Research Experience

**Research Assistant** April 2025 — June 2026
PI: Chen Lian *Berkeley, CA*

- **Project: "Why do Workers Dislike Inflation? Wage Erosion and Conflict Costs"**
  - Designed and implemented a numerically stable algorithm and associated solvers for the project's general equilibrium model.
  - Refactored and documented the Python replication package to improve readability and reproducibility.
- Reviewed mathematical derivations, prose, and formatting for research manuscripts on inflation, misallocation, fiscal policy, and household beliefs.

**Research Assistant** March 2025 — June 2025
PI: Serguei Maliar *Santa Clara, CA*

- **Project: "Using Reinforcement Learning to Solve Heterogeneous Agent Models"**
  - Implemented and tested K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN) based reinforcement learning algorithms in Python to solve the classic Krusell-Smith heterogeneous agent model.

**Research Assistant** April 2023 — July 2023
Author: Han Shi (PhD Thesis), PI: Bo Li *Beijing, China*

- **Project: "Intergovernmental Fiscal Relations, Public Resource Allocation and Coordinated Regional Development in China - A Perspective Based on Spatial Political Economy"**
  - Developed and implemented Nash equilibrium solving algorithms in MATLAB to analyze spatial political economy models.
  - Executed large-scale simulations on a high-performance computing (HPC) platform to obtain numerical results.

## Teaching Assistant Experiences

**Intermediate Macroeconomics (Honors)** Fall 2024
Instructor: Bo Zhao, National School of Development, Peking University *Beijing, China*

- Led weekly discussion sections.
- Supplemented lecture notes with relevant mathematical and economic concepts.
- Co-authored the midterm and final exams and graded problem sets.

**Computational Economics (Grad Level)** Spring 2026
Instructor: Bo Li, School of Economics, Peking University *Beijing, China*

- Taught numerical methods for solving macroeconomic models in Python with JAX.
- Prepared lecture slides and delivered in-class sessions.

## Student Activities

- Deputy Director, Cultural and Sports Department, Peking University Youth League Committee (Jan 2025–Jan 2026).
- Assistant Secretary-General, Peking University Student Art Troupe (July 2023–June 2024).

## Skills

- **Scientific Computing:** Fortran with OpenMP, Python with Jax/Numba, Matlab, Julia, Stata, C++ (Former competitive programmer)
- **Markup Languages:** LaTeX, Typst
- **Languages:** Mandarin (Native), English (Fluent)